

4 Do you need a camera on the tablet?

A common mistake people make while purchasing a tablet is that they look for a rear camera on the device. Are you really going to hold a 7-inch or 10-inch tablet in your hand to click a picture? What's more important is the front facing camera, you'll need it for when you're video chatting.



5 Quad-core on budget phone isn't the best

There are a lot of smartphones available starting at ₹9,000 that boast of a quad-core processor. Don't be fooled by them. Most of them are powered by a variant of the MediaTek MT 6589 chipset. Do your homework and check the device before purchasing. There are three variations of the chipset and you'll need to know which one your phone has if you're even hoping for decent performance.



6 Calling something an "ultrabook" doesn't mean that it's an "ultrabook"

Vendors are playing tricks on consumers by taking liberties by launching heavy, clunky laptops under the ultrabook umbrella. For something to qualify as an ultrabook, make sure it weighs less than 1.8kg, is running an Intel ULV processor (usually, the processor will have the suffix, U). More importantly, the laptop needs to be slim. Really slim.



7 Forget Megapixels, check the sensor size

The worst is probably when a salesman will try to pawn off a camera to you by saying "sir, this has more megapixels, it will give you better images." You take that very camera and beat him with it, asking if the extra MPs caused extra hurt.



8 Platform loyalty doesn't pay

Just because you've been a loyal customer for years doesn't mean that you have to remain one for the rest of your life. Experiment, check out what's new. Also, it's very likely that many of your old favourites are now dead and dying brands.



9 Upgradable OS, OTA and certifications

Android receives annual updates as far as the OS is concerned. When purchasing a tablet, you should take a look at the manufacturers support for updates. If you're picking up a tablet, check if it supports OTA (Over The Air) updates or you will have a lot of trouble with it in the future. Little known manufacturers might not even be certified by Google, meaning you won't get access to the Play store.



10 Touchpads: Size isn't everything. Accuracy is.

Unfortunately, the size of the touch pad does not guarantee a good, responsive experience. In fact, buggy implementation (especially drivers) can cause serious problems (read: an erratic pointer), especially when it comes to multi-touch gestures. Make sure you try the touch-pad before purchase; play a game of solitaire, browse the web, see if you can scroll comfortable and so on.



11 AA batteries may be large, but they're life savers

Custom lithium-ion batteries are great because they're tiny, but guess what? You get rechargeable AA cells as well and if there is one thing that is the bane of any photographer, that is running out of charge at the wrong (or right) time. A slim, Li-ion battery might ensure that your camera is slim, but nothing beats the comfort of being able to purchase a fully charged battery off the shelf.



12 Just because you have a keyboard doesn't mean you have a PC

A common mistake made by people is that they attach a keyboard to their tablet and think that it will work like a PC. Sure you may get a better typing experience but when it comes to office applications such as spreadsheet, nothing beats good old Windows or Mac. Plus, neither Android nor iOS is designed with a keyboard in mind. Of course, the Microsoft Surface might be a different beast altogether though.



13 "Complete ecosystem" is overrated

We have heard it so many times now - "You already have a MacBook? You must get an iPhone for proper integration". These are the kind of statements that are fallacious and don't make any sense. And yes, this applies to whatever the geniuses may have to tell you about the other ecosystems - Google, Windows etc. In fact, almost all manufacturers are doing their best to ensure that you have a seamless transition to their platform anyway. It's the apps that'll cost you when you switch platforms.

